

you have enough savings to cover the higher deductible. Here are four other suggestions that apply whether you own a home or rent.

- **Compare quotes.** Netquote.com and insweb.com will poll agents representing some of the biggest home insurance companies to see which has the best deals. You can also go to companies that sell directly to consumers, such as Amica (www.amica.com; 800-242-6422). Also contact State Farm (www.statefarm.com), which is one of the largest home insurance providers and sells through so-called captive agents (meaning they work only for State Farm). Active duty or retired military personnel and their families can go to USAA (www.usaa.com; 800-531-8080).
- **Ask if you're eligible for any discounts.** If you have dead-bolt locks on your doors or live in an apartment building with a doorman, you may be able to get a discount of as much as 10% on your premium. If you have a security alarm, a fire extinguisher, and a smoke detector, you can often get a discount of as much as 20%, depending on the type of system you have.
- **Consider moving your car coverage to the same insurance company as your homeowners or renters coverage.** Some companies will offer you a dual-policy discount of up to 15%.
- **Check with your state's insurance department.** It may publish a list of companies and the premiums they charge for homeowners insurance. (See Figure 8–1 for websites.) This can help you shop around.

CONSIDER AN UMBRELLA LIABILITY POLICY

If you have a lot of assets—or you have the potential to earn a lot—you should consider getting an **umbrella liability policy**. This special type of policy expands the liability protection provided by your car and homeowners coverage. It also may protect you in case